



reza hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>

*** * * **Subject: Formal Request for Review of Editorial Record Integrity – Manuscript IJA-2026-0085 (International Journal of Astrobiology)** **D...**

3 messages

Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity <publishingethics@cambridge.org>

Wed, Aug 5, 2026 at 4:27 PM

Reply-To: Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity <publishingethics@cambridge.org>

To: Reza Hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>

Joseph Ganderson (Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity)

5 Aug 2026, 12:57 UTC

Dear Dr Reza Hashemi,

Thank you for writing with us to express your concerns. Please be assured that we take such reports seriously, and we will follow up further on this. For reference, your dedicated Cambridge ethics case number is **1784**. You can use this in any correspondence with this inbox related to this concern. Otherwise, we handle many related cases, and so we ask for some patience while this is queued for our team to properly review the handling of your manuscript and your concerns.

Best regards,

Joseph

Dr. Joseph Ganderson

Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity (PERI)

Cambridge University Press

Reza Hashemi

3 Aug 2026, 10:02 UTC

Subject: Formal Request for Review of Editorial Record Integrity – Manuscript IJA-2026-0085 (International Journal of Astrobiology)**Dear Cambridge University Press Publishing Ethics Team,**

I am writing to formally request a review of the integrity and consistency of the official editorial record concerning manuscript IJA-2026-0085.

Manuscript details:

ID: IJA-2026-0085

Title: Environmental Selection of Thymine over Uracil in Prebiotic Chemical Evolution: Insights from a Kinetic Monte Carlo Model

Submitted: 9 July 2026

Decision date: 29 July 2026

This is not an appeal against the editorial decision. I fully accept the Editor's authority to desk-reject a manuscript without external peer review. My concern is strictly limited to the accuracy and internal consistency of the documented editorial process.

The official record currently contains clear and unresolved inconsistencies:

1. The decision letter of 29 July 2026 explicitly stated that "the comments of the reviewer(s) which led to this decision can be found at the bottom of this letter." The section "Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author" was, however, completely empty.
2. The Editorial Office later stated that this wording was merely a default system template and that the manuscript had never been sent for peer review.
3. The Associate Editor subsequently confirmed in writing that she had entered comments explaining the rejection into a comment box, but those comments did not appear in the letter sent to the author.
4. ScholarOne displayed the status "Awaiting Reviewer Selection" on 25 July 2026 and "Awaiting Associate Editor-in-Chief Decision" on 29 July 2026. No satisfactory explanation has been provided for what the "Awaiting Reviewer Selection" status represented in a case that, according to the Editorial Office, never entered peer review.
5. No scientific justification of any kind was ever communicated to the author for the desk rejection.

These statements cannot be reconciled with one another.

The result is an official editorial record that is internally inconsistent and lacks transparency.

I raised these points successively with the Editorial Office, the Associate Editor, and the Editor-in-Chief. The inconsistencies remain unresolved.

Given that Cambridge University Press is committed to the principles of transparency and best practice in scholarly publishing, I request that your team conduct a procedural review of the editorial handling and documentation of this manuscript and provide a clear clarification of the points listed above.

I am requesting that the official record be accurate, consistent, and transparent.

I am prepared to supply the full correspondence and ScholarOne screenshots immediately upon request. I also request that this correspondence be placed on the official file of manuscript IJA-2026-0085.

Looking forward to your response.

Yours sincerely,

Dr Seyed Mohammad Reza Hashemi (Reza Hashemi)

Independent Researcher

ORCID: 0009-0002-0645-5180

mrhashemi2000@gmail.com

Cambridge University Press & Assessment is the publishing and assessment department of the University of Cambridge. The corporate title of the University is *The Chancellor, Masters, and Scholars of the University of Cambridge*. Our principal office is at Shaftesbury Road, Cambridge, CB2 8EA, United Kingdom, with registered VAT number GB 823 8476 09. We are a not-for-profit organisation and an exempt charity under the Charities Act 2011.

Disclaimer

This email is intended solely for the recipient and may contain confidential information. If you have received this email in error, please let us know and then delete the original email and any attachments. Do not use, copy or

disclose the contents of this email or any attachment. Any views or opinions in this email are solely those of the author and do not necessarily represent those of Cambridge, unless specifically stated.

Attachment(s)[092454 29-07-2026 تصویر صفحه.png](#)[203326 29-07-2026 تصویر صفحه.png](#)[095056 03-08-2026 تصویر صفحه.png](#)[Gmail - International Journal of Astrobiology - Decision on IJA-2026-0085.pdf](#)[114327 25-07-2026 تصویر صفحه.png](#)

This email is a service from Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity. Delivered by Zendesk

[5KZ40W-7K5KP]

Reza Hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>

Thu, Aug 27, 2026 at 4:31 AM

To: Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity <publishingethics@cambridge.org>

Re: Formal Request for Review of Editorial Record Integrity – **Manuscript IJA-2026-0085 (case 1784)**

Dear Dr Joseph Ganderson,

Thank you for your reply dated 5 August 2026 (**case 1784**).

I have not received any update or timeline for the procedural review of the editorial record despite 22 days having now passed.

The full manuscript and source code (UPDSF v4.4) were publicly released on Zenodo on 6 & 9 July 2026 — days before the desk rejection — with no scientific justification provided for the absence of peer review.<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21270652> , <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21224889>

I respectfully request an immediate status update and a specific date for a substantive response.

Best regards,

Dr Reza Hashemi

mrhashemi2000@gmail.com

<https://orcid.org/0009-0002-0645-5180>

[Quoted text hidden]

Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity <publishingethics@cambridge.org>

Wed, Sep 2, 2026 at 3:01 PM

Reply-To: Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity <publishingethics@cambridge.org>

To: Reza Hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>

Joseph Ganderson (Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity)

2 Sept 2026, 11:31 UTC

Dear Dr Hashemi,

First, let me apologise for not replying now, I have personally been on leave in recent weeks. However, I did

contact the journal to request an explanation and understand further what happened here.

Unfortunately, this stems from a technical issue in the journal's management system, whereby Associate Editors must select '0 reviews are necessary' in order to indicate an editorial decision of 'desk reject without further review'. In the template letter, the following sentence is automatically included, even when the article is not sent out for review:

The comments of the reviewer(s) which led to this decision can be found at the bottom of this letter.

I have further liaised with the editor in question, and they have explained to me that the manuscript was treated with the normal due consideration. The new journal receives a very high number of submissions, and was queued for initial review. After this, the Associate Editor cited concerns about quality, and in particular with respect to the referencing of the proposed paper ('There is a lack of reference to previous or related publications'), which they deemed not to fit with the International Journal of Astrobiology. I understand that you might not agree with this conclusion, but it is the editorial conclusion that the journal stands by.

I apologise for the understandable impression that you received that the article had been sent for external peer review. I will liaise with the journal and ScholarOne to try to address this to prevent a recurrence,

In the meantime, you are of course welcome to resubmit to the journal at any time. I want to wish you all the best with your ongoing research.

Kind regards,

Joseph

Dr. Joseph Ganderson
Publishing Ethics and Research Integrity (PERI)

Cambridge University Press

Reza Hashemi

27 Aug 2026, 01:02 UTC

Re: Formal Request for Review of Editorial Record Integrity – **Manuscript IJA-2026-0085 (case 1784)**

Dear Dr Joseph Ganderson,

Thank you for your reply dated 5 August 2026 (**case 1784**).

I have not received any update or timeline for the procedural review of the editorial record despite 22 days having now passed.

The full manuscript and source code (UPDSF v4.4) were publicly released on Zenodo on 6 & 9 July 2026 — days before the desk rejection — with no scientific justification provided for the absence of peer review.<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21270652> , <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21224889>

I respectfully request an immediate status update and a specific date for a substantive response.

Best regards,

Dr Reza Hashemi

mrhashemi2000@gmail.com

<https://orcid.org/0009-0002-0645-5180>

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]